

Mice

The GyroMouse from Gyratation is already available in the market—it uses a gyroscope instead of a ball or optical technology. This mouse doesn't need a surface—all the user needs to do is hold it in his hand and move it.

The GyroMouse mouse is expensive and therefore not widely available. The Mouse Glove is a wearable device fashioned in the form of a glove. This will indeed revolutionise the way one uses PCs. It is being developed for people suffering from RSI (Repetitive Stress Injury), and will also be marketed as a gaming tool.

Facts

Mouse technology has survived so long mostly

because it harmonises almost perfectly with human hand-eye coordination.

■ Douglas Engelbart invented the “X-Y Position Indicator for a Display System” in the 1960s, and owns the patent for it. Today, we call it the mouse.

■ The first computer mouse was built of carved wood, and had one small red button that was used to select items on a computer monitor. There was no room inside the casing for a second button because the electronics used in the mouse were too large.

■ The first mice used two perpendicular wheels that stuck out of the bottom. Later, the mouse was given a ball, which was next to a

shaft. The mouse ball technology became nearly universal. The technology is still the most widely used, though other technologies have been developed.

Ready Reckoner	
 You Need	A cheap yet comfortable mouse
Look for	An optical scroll mouse with PS/2 interface and a USB to PS/2 converter available out of the box
 You Need	Extreme Precision and supreme comfort
Look for	Wireless optical scroll mouse with extra hotkeys and preferably USB interface



Buying Tips

- ✓ **TYPE OF MECHANISM:** Optical mice are better than the old-fashioned ball ones. They are accurate and don't require cleaning.
- ✓ **TYPE OF WIRELESS:** Unlike infrared, RF wireless connectivity doesn't require the mouse to be within line-of-sight. This makes an RF wireless mouse the obvious choice.
- ✓ **ADD-ON CONNECTOR:** Ensure that the manufacturer provides an USB to PS/2 converter, in case you have to use the device on the PS/2 port.
- ✓ **TYPE OF SCROLLING:** Some mice support only vertical scrolling, while some support horizontal scrolling as well. A mouse that offers both provides greater ease of use while browsing through Web pages or documents that are unusually large.
- ✓ **CABLE LENGTH:** Check if the cable is long enough to

reach your cabinet.

- ✓ **NUMBER OF BUTTONS:** Opt for a three-button mouse rather than a two-button mouse. The middle button can be customised. Some mice provide you more than three customisable buttons, which come in useful while browsing, gaming, etc.
- ✓ **SYMMETRY:** Some mice are perfectly symmetrical, and hence can be used either by a left-handed or a right-handed person. These can be less comfortable than one that is moulded for the right hand, so do try them out before you buy.
- ✓ **INTERFACE:** A device with a PS/2 interface should be preferred over a serial mouse or a USB-based mouse, since that interface offers the most backward compatibility, while leaving the serial ports free for other peripherals.